

Return-to-Play $\neq$ Return-to-Form

Database Study of 2,335 Footballers

Return-to-Play and Performance Recovery in European Footballers: Are Players Truly Back to Form?

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Presenter Relationship Disclosure

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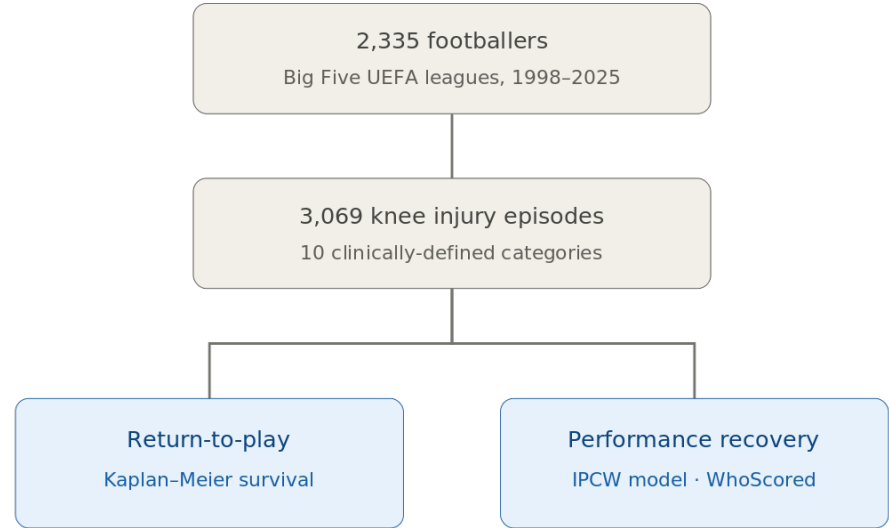
Relationships with financial sponsors in the past two years:

- Any direct financial relationships including receipt of honoraria: N/A
- Funded grants or clinical trials: N/A
- Memberships on advisory boards or speakers' bureau: N/A
- Patents for drugs or devices: N/A
- Other: N/A

Any other Financial Disclosures: No Disclosures

Background & Methods

Knee injuries are among the most common and career-impacting injuries in professional football
RTP timelines are well-documented, but whether players regain their pre-injury performance remains largely unstudied



Two parallel outcome analyses

Results

Median return: **95 days**

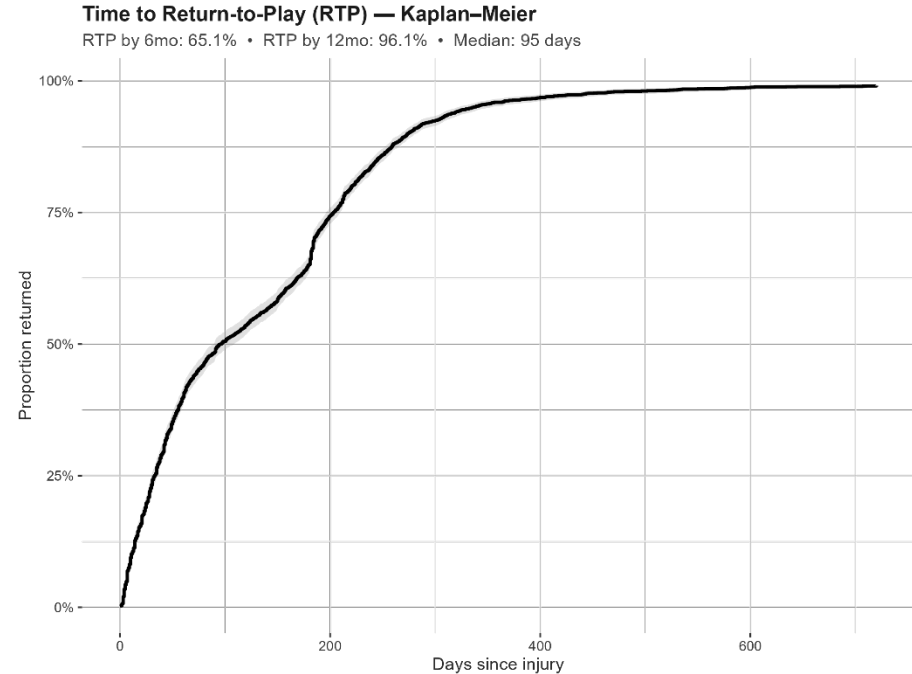
65% returned by 6 months

96% returned by 12 months

Slowest-recovering injuries:

- Cruciate ligament tears
- Chondral and osteochondral injuries
- Patellar tendon rupture

RTP did not differ by playing position
(all positions $\approx 65\%$ at 6mo, $\approx 96\%$ at 12mo)



Results & Clinical Implications

RTP did **not** equal return-to-form:

- Performance remained **0.10 pts (0.26 SD)** below baseline after 2 yrs

Counsel players (and clubs): clinical recovery does not guarantee performance recovery

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Scan to view Detailed Results and Individual Player Data

